TCS India FAQs – Work from Office Non-Compliance

VERSION 6.0

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Document Release Notice

This FAQ on Work from Office Non-Compliance, Version 6.0, is released for use in TATA Consultancy Services (TCS) with effect from 22 May 2026.

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The latest version of this document is available on the HR Policy Hub.

This document was last reviewed / updated on 22 May 2026.

Approved By: Haridas Menon U. **Date**: 22 May 2026
(Global Head – Policy & Talent Transformation)

Authorized By: Sudeep Kunnumal **Date**: 22 May 2026
(Chief Human Resources Officer)

Introduction

TCS India Policy - Working Hours and the **TCS India (BPS) Policy - Working Hours** defines the Working Hours for the organization, which every employee is expected to comply with at all times from 'TCS designated work premises' (any reference to this includes TCS offices, Client locations or any other TCS designated physical location for the scope of this document).

The TCS India Guideline – WFO Non-compliance lays down the actions and consequences which will follow in the event that an employee is found to be in violation of the expectations of working from office and the provisions laid down in these policies.

TCS views these organization imperatives in a serious light and any violations to the same will attract strict disciplinary action. This document has been drafted in alignment to the **TCS India Guideline – WFO Non-compliance**.

WFO Index calculation:

1. How is the individual WFO Index calculated?

The WFO Index is calculated monthly based on valid WFO events captured in system during the month.

Monthly WFO Index = Total valid WFO Event in a month / Net Working days in a month

2. How is my WFO compliance being captured in the system?

Total valid WFO Count captured for an employee in a month includes a valid system captured through any of the following events:

1. Swipe records at TCS office premises.
2. Approved Short term travel requests.
3. Approved Leave records (including Timesheet leaves).
4. Approved WFO Exceptions.

In case there are multiple events captured towards a particular working day, a single-unique WFO count will be considered for the working day. Please note, Swipe records will take precedence over other events.

For example,
An employee works for 16 working days at the TCS designated premises, avails 1 day of leave (approved in system), 2 days of approved exception to work from office and travels for official purposes for 2 working days.
The employee's valid WFO count shall be: 16+1+2+2 = 21

3. How many days do I have to work from the office every month?

Employees are expected to work from the designated TCS office on all working days of the month.

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4. I am unable to work from the office. What is the procedure to seek an exception?

Reasonable Accommodation has been made available to employees who have sought documented exception under the enhanced "WFO Exception" module. Employees are expected to discuss any need for flexibility with their supervisors and HR team and on the basis of the directions received, raise the request in the system. For legitimate reasons recognized by organization and mentioned below, employees may request an exception to WFO:

Reasons	Sub-Reasons
Missing WFO Entry	a. Missing Swipe Record b. Missing Travel Record c. Missing Leave Record d. Branch Holiday Mismatch
WFO Non TCS Office	a. Work From Client Location b. Attending business meetings, seminars, training etc. c. Campus Recruitments, Visits d. Compensatory WFH e. Calamity or Exigency* (For e.g. *heavy rainfall, earthquake, bandh, strike, rally*, geopolitical situations *etc.*)
Infrastructure	a. Network or Laptop Issue b. Inadequate seat capacity
Personal Flexibility	a. Personal Flexibility
Flexible Work Options	a. As per the provisions laid down in the **TCS India Policy – Flexible work arrangements**

These requests are reviewed on a case-to-case basis depending upon the severity of the situation. Hence, these need to be discussed with the HR BP and supervisor in advance. Employees are required to apply for an WFO exception on the below path: *Ultimatix > Applications > Employee Services > Global ESS > My Profile > WFO Exception > Raise Request*

Note: *Please note, only approved requests of 'WFO Exception' are considered towards valid WFO count.*

5. What are the timelines for getting an exception request approved in the system?

All types of Exceptions should be approved within 10 days or before 10th of the month, whichever comes earlier to avoid the impact on WFO index %. All exception requests will be rejected on the 10th day from the date of raising the request.

The only exception are the requests made under the 'Personal Flexibility' category where the supervisor must act within 5 calendar days from the date of initiation of the request, failing which the request will be auto approved at midnight on the 5th day from the date of raising the request. In this case also, the request must be in approved state by the 10th of the month.

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6. Where can I check my WFO Index details?

Employees can check their WFO Index under the below path:

Ultimatix > Applications > Finance & Infrastructure > Physical Infrastructure > 2Office

7. I am unallocated. How many days do I have to report to the office every month?

Unallocated employees are expected to report to their RMG SPOCs at depute office location on all working days of the month to ensure 100% compliance to WFO.

8. I am going on a leave for 10 working days in June 2026. Will this be accounted in the computation of WFO Index?

Yes, an approved leave is considered as a valid WFO count.

9. I applied for an exception to WFO for 5 days due to some personal flexibility. Shall this be accounted in the computation of WFO Index?

WFO count considers approved requests of exceptions as valid inputs towards computation of WFO Index. Please note, only approved requests are considered and applied requests are not considered. Further, employees can only raise a maximum of 6 days of exceptions under 'Personal Flexibility' category in a quarter. Un-availed exceptions cannot be carried forward to the subsequent quarters.

10. I was required to work from home due to personal flexibility from 25th to 27th June 2025. Till when can I apply for a request of exception to WFO for it to be considered towards WFO count of June?

All employees are required to plan, discuss with supervisor and raise requests for exceptions in advance and ensure the requests are approved before working from home.
In case of an emergency requiring immediate work from home, employees are expected to raise the request under "Personal Flexibility" in the 'WFO Exception' module on GESS.
Backdated Personal Flexibility Exception requests can be raised maximum up to 2 previous days from current date & future dated requests up to next 5 days with a maximum of 3 days in one request

11. I have applied for a business travel for 4 days to another branch in the coming week. Shall this be accounted in the computation of WFO Index?

WFO count considers approved requests for business travel as valid inputs towards computation of WFO Index. Please note, only approved Travel requests in GESS travel system are considered

In case the business travel requests are raised two-ways on GESS under same travel request number and approved, the intermittent working days shall be considered as valid inputs towards WFO Index computation. However, in cases where the travel requests are raised for one-way only, the intermittent working days shall not be considered. In such situations, employees shall be required to work from TCS India Office premises or raise an exception request as applicable under the WFO Exceptions module in GESS if working from client location.

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12. My project DC is at office location 'A', but I am working from office location 'B' for 2 days due to a client meeting. Shall this be accounted as a valid input towards computation of WFO Index?

Yes, BMS swipe records at TCS office premises are considered towards a valid WFO count.

13. I have applied for a short-term deputation / business travel with one-way ticket. Will my WFO compliance get impacted?

Yes

i. If travel is within India with one-way ticket and the return ticket is booked under a new travel request, then the intermittent working days shall not be taken into consideration if you are not working from TCS India office location.

   In case you are working from Customer site or for campus recruitment or attending business meetings then the WFO exception request needs to be raised under the appropriate category in the WFO exception module in GESS.

Note: *Since a separate travel request will need to be raised for the return travel if you are not working from a TCS location during the period of travel, it is mandatory to raise exception on the 4th day from the travel start date and should be approved within 10 days or before 10th of the month, whichever is earlier.*

ii. If travel is out of India without return ticket, then exception should be raised on the 8th day from the travel start date and should be approved within 10 days or before 10th of the month, whichever is earlier.

Note: *Since a separate travel request will need to be raised for the return travel, it is mandatory to raise WFO exception on the 8th day from the travel start date and should be approved within 10 days or before 10th of the month whichever is earlier.*

Follow the WFO exception process via "GESS -> My Profile -> WFO exception -> Missing WFO Entry -> Missing Travel Record".

14. I am working in a depute location 'A' different from my S/WON location 'B'. The Government has declared a holiday for depute location 'A', which is not defined for S/WON location 'B'. How will this be shown in 2Office application and what should employee do in case of No Show?

An employee can discuss with the manager to avail WFO exception on depute location holiday and raise the request under "Missing WFO Entry > Branch Holiday Mismatch" in the 'WFO Exception' module on GESS.
Please note, requests under "Missing WFO Entry" are to be raised after 3 days of the missing swipe entry reflecting as 'No Show' in the 2Office module.

15. I worked from office on Monday however missed filling my timesheet and a timesheet leave was generated due to default. Shall this be accounted towards computation of WFO Index?

Yes, WFO count considers timesheet leaves (assuming this leave will not be cancelled) as valid inputs towards the computation of WFO Index. However, we strongly urge all our employees to ensure 100% adherence to timesheet compliance.

16. I missed filling my timesheet, a timesheet leave was generated due to default. I cancelled this time sheet leave. How shall this impact the computation of WFO Index?

If the employee cancels the timesheet leave, any one of the following events shall be considered as a valid WFO count:

a. Swipe records at TCS Office premises if the employee is present in the office.
b. An approved request for leave/ business travel by the employee.
c. An approved exception request raised under the WFO Exceptions module in GESS.

17. I had raised an exception to WFO in the system prior to the date; however, it was not approved in time. How can I re-raise it?

Employees are expected to apply exceptions in the WFO Exception module in advance to allow reasonable time for review. They are required to ensure these planned requests are approved prior to proceeding to work from home.

In case of a time-critical request, please connect with your Manager and HR BP for specific guidance.

Special Scenarios:

18. I have recently returned from a long-term assignment from an overseas TCS location to TCS India. How shall my WFO Index be calculated?

WFO Index will be calculated only if Depute country is changed to India. Calculated Index will be applicable for the entire quarter.

For employees returning from an international long-term assignment, the WFO Index for the month of return will be exempted. WFO Index will be calculated only for those months when employee is in India basis depute country and, in this case, the consequence will be applied based on the WFO index calculated for the quarter. However, for employees returning from an international long-term assignment in the last month of the quarter, WFO Index will not be calculated, therefore, be exempted from the consequence impact of the given quarter.

If any further exemptions are required, the employees may reach out to their respective supervisors/HRBP.

Employees proceeding on an international long-term assignment in any month of the quarter will be exempted from the impact of the given quarter.

For example, *an employee returned from overseas on the 17th of May 2026. The WFO Index shall be exempted for April and May and shall be calculated utilizing the WFO Index of June for the Quarter. For an employee returning from overseas after international long-term assignment on the 21st of June 2026, the WFO Index shall be exempted for the entire quarter.*

19. I have resumed office post LWP of 6 months. How shall my WFO Index be calculated?

For employees resuming post LWP, the WFO Index for the month in which the employee is resuming from LWP, will be exempted (based on Assignment Status change). WFO Index will be calculated only for those months when employee is Active assignment status and in this case, the consequence will be applied based on the WFO index calculated for the quarter If Employees were on LWP in the first 2 months of the quarter and resuming post LWP in the last month of quarter, they will be exempted from the consequence impact for the given quarter as WFO index will not be calculated.

If any further exemptions are required, the employees may reach out to their respective supervisors/HRBP.

Employees proceeding on LWP in any month of the quarter will be exempted from the impact of the given quarter.

For example, *an employee resumed post LWP on the 12th of April 2026. The WFO Index shall be exempted for April and shall be calculated utilizing the WFO Index of May and June for the Quarter.*

For an employee who was on LWP in April 2026 and May 2026 and is returning from LWP on the 11th of June 2026, the WFO Index shall be exempted for the entire quarter.

20. I am resuming from maternity leave on the 4th of August 2026. How shall my WFO index be calculated?

WFO Index will be calculated basis approved leaves (maternity leaves) in GESS

21. I joined TCS on 20th May 2026. How shall my WFO Index be calculated?

The WFO Index for new joiners shall be calculated from the month subsequent to the month of joining. They shall be exempted from WFO Index calculation for the month of joining. WFO Index will be calculated only for those months when employee is in India with Active assignment status. However, employees joining in the last month of the quarter will be exempted from the consequence impact for the given quarter.

22. I have been working from the office. However, the BMS swipes records are not reflected correctly. Will this impact my WFO compliance? How shall I get this corrected?

Yes. WFO compliance will get impacted if corrective action is not taken in a timely manner. BMS swipe records are refreshed on the subsequent day. However, if the records do not get updated even after 3 days, employees are required to inform their supervisor and raise an exception under WFO Exception module (Category – Missing WFO Entry) after 3 days of the missing swipe entry reflecting as 'No Show' in 2Office module and get the exception approved by supervisor.

23. I have been facing issues towards working from office on all days as is expected due to constraints in seating capacity. Will this impact my WFO compliance? How will this be accounted in the computation of WFO Index?

Yes, this will impact WFO compliance if exceptions are not raised under **Inadequate Seat Capacity** and approved by your supervisor in Exception Module. Employes facing any issues towards working from office due to project related seat constraint, should connect with their supervisor who can review the issue and allocate the seat for the upcoming days. Exceptions need to be raised under the category "Infrastructure > Inadequate Seat Capacity".

24. I have been asked to work at the customer's office location two days a week for the next three months. Will this impact my WFO compliance? How will this be accounted in the computation of WFO index?

Employees required to work from client location on business request should raise an exception under the category "WFO Non TCS Office > Work from Client Location".

Consequence of Non-compliance:

25. I did not adhere to the WFO compliance this month, can I overcome this by working additional working days in the subsequent month?

While the WFO Index is calculated for a month, the consequence will be applied for quarterly WFO Index, which will be = average of Monthly WFO Index for the 3 months of each quarter.
Please connect with your HR BP and supervisor for specific queries.

For example, *the net working days for an employee is 20 days for each month of a quarter. An employee works for 8 days in Month 1, 22 days in Month 2 and 20 days in Month 3.*
The monthly WFO Index shall be 40% for Month 1, 100% for Month 2 and 100% for Month 3.
The Quarterly WFO Index shall be calculated as:
Quarterly WFO Index = (40+100+100)/3 =80%

26. What happens if I am non-compliant to the expected WFO Index?

In the event an employee is found to be in violation of the expected WFO compliance, there shall be implications on annual performance review, compensation and career progression.

Impact on your Performance Pay in the first month of the subsequent quarter following WFO non-compliance will be as below:

Quarterly WFO Index	Performance Pay
>=85%	100%
>=75 & < 85%	90%
>=50 & < 75%	75%
>=25 & < 50%	50%
<25%	0%

The percentage of Performance Pay that will be made in the first month of the subsequent quarter will be based on the Quarterly WFO index of the previous quarter. Please refer to the **TCS India Guideline – WFO Non-compliance** for specific details on the impact on the Performance Pay based on the WFO Index.

27. How will my Performance Pay be impacted each month depending on my WFO compliance?

Your Performance Pay, as defined in your Compensation Letter, will continue to be paid out on a monthly basis. The percentage of Performance Pay that will be made in the first month of the subsequent quarter will be based on the Quarterly WFO index of the previous quarter.

Example 1 *- The net working days for an employee are 20 days for each month of a quarter and the WFO compliance is as below:*

Month	*Net Working Days*	*WFO Days*	*Monthly WFO Index*
Month 1	*20*	*18*	*90%*
Month 2	*20*	*17*	*85%*
Month 3	*20*	*16*	*80%*

The Quarterly WFO Index is calculated as the ***average of the Monthly WFO Index values*** *for the three months in the quarter:*

$$\text{Quarterly WFO Index} = \frac{90\% + 85\% + 80\%}{3} = 85\%$$

The impact on Performance Pay for WFO index of >= 85% is a 100% payout, therefore, no impact would be made to the Performance Pay in the first month of the subsequent quarter.

Example 2, *the net working days for an employee is 20 days for each month of a quarter and the WFO compliance is as below.*

Month	*Net Working Days*	*WFO Days*	*Monthly WFO Index*
Month 1	*20*	*8*	*40%*
Month 2	*20*	*5*	*25%*
Month 3	*20*	*3*	*15%*

The Quarterly WFO Index is calculated as the ***average of the Monthly WFO Index values*** *for the three months in the quarter:*

$$\text{Quarterly WFO Index} = \frac{40\% + 25\% + 15\%}{3} = 27\%$$

The impact on Performance Pay for WFO index of >=25 & < 50% is 50% payout of the Performance Pay. Therefore, the performance pay paid out in month 4 (i.e. the first month of the subsequent quarter) will be reduced by 50% of the average of the Performance Pay of the previous quarter.

Please refer to the **TCS India Guideline – WFO Non-compliance** for specific details on the impact on the Performance Pay based on the WFO Index.

28. Are grade and anniversary deferred by a quarter or by the exact number of days of non-compliance?

In case the employee is non-adherent to the WFO compliance threshold of 60%, the anniversary grade movement will defer till the WFO compliance threshold is achieved.

Accordingly, the effective date for any Total Rewards interventions (including but not restricted to annual performance review, compensation and career progression) will be shifted to the 1st of the quarter, subsequent to the one in which WFO compliance threshold is met.

Please note, notwithstanding the above, impact on performance pay shall be made for WFO Index in line with the table mentioned above (Question No.26) and published in the ***TCS India Guideline - WFO Non-Compliance****.*

Revision List

Revision No.	Policy effective date	Revision date	Revision description	Section No.	Rationale for change	Change type (add/modify/delete)	Policy revision/ Document revision
6.0	22 May 2026	22 May 2026	Sub reason 'Calamity' under WFO Non TCS Office category renamed to 'Calamity or Exigency' covering broader reasons.	Question 4	To align with the revised WFO exception module	Modify	Policy Revision
6.0	22 May 2026	22 May 2026	'Personal Exigency' category renamed to 'Personal Flexibility'.	Question 4	To align with the revised WFO exception module	Modify	Policy Revision
6.0	22 May 2026	22 May 2026	Sub reasons under 'Personal Flexibility' removed.	Question 4	To align with the revised WFO exception module	Modify	Policy Revision
6.0	22 May 2026	22 May 2026	The approvals required for requests raised under Personal flexibility revised from 10 days to 5 days post which auto approval.	Question 5	To align with the revised WFO exception module	Modify	Policy Revision
5.0	1 April 2026	17 May 2026	Clarified employees returning from overseas assignment or LWP to connect with Supervisor/HRBP for any WFO exemptions required.	Question 18 & 19	Better Clarity	Modify	Policy Revision
5.0	1 April 2026	17 May 2026	Clarified the treatment for employees proceeding on LWP and to overseas assignment	Question 18 & 19	Better Clarity	Modify	Policy Revision
5.0	01 April 2026	17 May 2026	Impact of WFO index on Performance Pay explained.	Question 26 & 27	As per current approach on compensation	Modify	Policy Revision
4.0	15 January 2026	19 January 2026	Sub reasons for each legitimate reason added.	Question 4	Better clarity	Modify	Policy Revision
4.0	15 January 2026	19 January 2026	Updated the path to raise WFO exception request.	Question 4	Better clarity	Modify	Document Revision
3.0	01 October 2025	21 November 2025	Added a question on impact of WFO index in case of employees on official travel.	Question 13	To align with the current process	Add	Policy Revision
3.0	01 October 2025	21 November 2025	Added a question on the timelines for WFO exception requests approvals/rejections process.	Question 5	To align with the current process	Add	Policy Revision
2.0	01 April 2025	13 August 2025	Removal of questions on rostering in 2Office module	Earlier marked as Questions 6 & 7	Not applicable as per current process	Modify	Policy Revision
2.0	01 April 2025	13 August 2025	Modification made to the legitimate reasons recognized as exceptions to WFO	Question 4, 21 & 22	To align with the WFO Exception module in GESS	Modify	Policy Revision
1.0	01 April 2024	29 July 2024	New Release	NA	NA	NA	NA